STUDENT SPENDING & EXPENSES BEHAVIOR ANALYSIS

Spending Patterns · Savings Behaviour · Financial Risk · DAX Documentation

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Dataset: 82 Respondents | 10+ Variables | 3 Dashboard Pages

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1. Problem Statement

Financial management is one of the most critical yet underexplored aspects of student life in India. College students navigate a complex balancing act between limited monthly allowances — primarily funded by parents — and a growing array of spending categories including food, transportation, shopping, study materials, and entertainment. With the rapid shift from cash to digital payment methods, spending behaviour has also become harder for students to track, resulting in a sizeable gap between what students earn in allowances and what they actually save.

This study aims to understand the spending patterns, savings behaviour, and overall financial discipline of college students across different academic programmes and years of study. Specifically, it seeks to identify which courses and demographic groups exhibit the highest and lowest savings rates, which spending categories dominate student budgets, and whether financial tracking habits meaningfully influence savings outcomes. The findings are intended to guide financial literacy programmes, student welfare policies, and institutional support structures.

This study addresses the following key questions:

- What are the primary spending categories consuming student allowances?
- How do spending and savings patterns vary across academic courses and study years?
- Does tracking expenses lead to measurably better savings outcomes for students?

2. Collection of Data

Data was collected through a structured Google Form survey distributed digitally to student respondents across various college programmes in India. The form was designed to capture a comprehensive picture of student financial behaviour without requiring access to actual bank records, making it accessible to a broad respondent base across multiple academic disciplines and years of study.

The survey comprised questions covering demographic details (course, gender, year of study), monthly allowances received from parents or other income sources, total monthly spending, food expenses, primary spending categories, payment method preferences, and expense tracking habits. Responses were collected on a voluntary basis and the final dataset comprises 82 complete responses.

Data was collected using a convenience sampling method, where respondents were selected based on accessibility and willingness to participate. While this approach enabled quick and efficient data collection, it may introduce demographic bias, as the sample may not fully represent the full diversity of the Indian student population across different institution types and geographic regions.

3. Dataset

The dataset contains 82 rows and over 10 columns. Each row represents one student respondent. The columns and their descriptions, distributions, insights, and recommendations are detailed below.

I. Course

This column classifies respondents by their current academic programme. It is used to study how spending patterns and financial discipline differ across disciplines.

Field	Details
B.A.	Sample respondents — liberal arts
B.Com	Commerce students
B.Tech	Engineering students
BBA	Business administration students
M.B.B.S	Medical students — highest avg spending

II. Gender

This column captures respondent gender, enabling analysis of whether spending and savings behaviours differ by gender.

Field	Details
Female	Largest respondent group
Male	Second respondent group
Others	Small representation

III. Year of Study

Records the current academic year of the respondent — a proxy for financial experience and independence.

Field	Details
1st Year	Lowest average savings
2nd Year	Building financial habits

3rd Year	Mid-range savers
4th Year	Highest average savings (~₹9,000+)

IV. Monthly Allowance

The primary income variable — the self-reported monthly allowance each student receives.

₹16,360	₹820K	₹10,000	₹6,360
Average Allowance	Total Dataset Spending	Average Spending	Average Savings

V. Monthly Spending

The primary outcome variable — total self-reported monthly expenditure per student.

Field	Details
Average	₹10,000 per month
Total (all respondents)	₹820,000
Average Savings Rate	38.89%
Highest Savings Recorded	₹22,000

VI. Top Spending Categories

Identifies the primary spending category for each respondent — the main target for financial counselling efforts.

Field	Details
Transport	Highest-ranked spending category
Study Materials	Second most common category
Shopping	Third most common category
Food	Fourth most common category
Entertainment	Fifth most common category

VII. Payment Method

Records the primary payment method used by each student.

80.49%	19.51%	80.49%
Digital Payments 66 respondents	**Cash Payments** 16 respondents	**Digital Payment %** Dominant method

VIII. Expense Tracking

Captures whether respondents actively track their daily or monthly expenses.

Field	Details
Yes	Only 31.71% of students track expenses
No	Majority do not track
Rarely	Occasional tracking behaviour

IX. Weekly Food Expense

Records the average weekly food expenditure — the most frequent and observable spending category.

₹1,080	M.B.B.S	B.A.
Avg Weekly Food Expense	**Highest Food Spenders**	**Lowest Food Spenders**

X. Risk Level

A derived variable classifying students into financial risk tiers based on their spending-to-allowance ratio.

Field	Details
Safe	Largest group — spend well within allowance
Moderate	Spending close to allowance limit
High Risk	10.98% of students — spending exceeds or nearly matches allowance

4. Power Query

The dataset required moderate cleaning prior to analysis. Power Query was used to standardise categorical fields, validate data types, and create derived columns necessary for risk and savings segmentation.

A key transformation step involved creating a Savings column by subtracting Monthly Spending from Monthly Allowance. This derived variable forms the backbone of Dashboard 2 (Savings Behaviour Analysis) and all savings-related KPIs. An additional Savings Level column was created using conditional logic to classify each student as High, Medium, or Low saver based on their computed savings value. This grouping reduces individual-level noise and enables cleaner segment comparisons across course and gender.

A Risk Level classification was also introduced using a conditional column that evaluated each student's Expense Ratio (Monthly Spending / Monthly Allowance). Students with a ratio above 0.90 were classified as High Risk, those between 0.60 and 0.90 as Moderate, and those below 0.60 as Safe. This segmentation — used extensively in Dashboard 3 (Financial Behaviour Analysis) — enables identification of financially vulnerable students requiring targeted intervention.

Overall, the Power Query process balanced data preparation with interpretive structure — ensuring that the raw survey responses could be transformed into actionable financial behaviour categories without distorting the original data distribution.

5. DAX Measures Used in Power BI

The following DAX measures were created in Power BI to power all KPI cards and chart calculations across all three dashboard pages. Each measure is documented with its formula, purpose, and the visual it supports.

I. Total Spending

DAX Formula:

```
Total Spending = SUM('Student Data'[Monthly_Spending])
```

Purpose: Computes the total monthly spending across all respondents. Displayed as the '820K' KPI card on Dashboard 1 and used as the baseline for understanding aggregate financial outflow from the student population.

Why Used: SUM is the appropriate aggregation for understanding total financial burden. It contextualises the average spending figure — an ₹820K monthly outflow across only 82 students signals significant collective financial activity for a population primarily dependent on parental support.

II. Average Allowance

DAX Formula:

```
Avg Allowance = AVERAGE('Student Data'[Monthly_Allowance])
```

Purpose: Calculates the mean monthly allowance received by students. Displayed as the '16.36K' KPI card on Dashboard 1 and used as the baseline denominator for all savings and risk ratio calculations.

Why Used: AVERAGE is used rather than median because allowances in this dataset do not exhibit extreme outlier skew. Comparing average allowance against average spending (₹16,360 vs ₹10,000) immediately reveals the theoretical savings headroom, contextualising why the 38.89% savings rate is achievable in principle but unevenly distributed in practice.

III. Average Savings

DAX Formula:

```
Avg Savings = AVERAGE('Student Data'[Savings])
```

Purpose: Computes the mean monthly savings (Allowance - Spending). Shown as the '6.36K' KPI card on Dashboard 2 and used as the primary Y-axis metric in all savings segmentation charts.

Why Used: Savings is the most direct measure of financial health for students. Presenting it as an average KPI alongside course and gender breakdowns enables immediate identification of which student segments are most and least financially secure.

IV. Savings Rate %

DAX Formula:

```
Savings Rate = DIVIDE(SUM('Student Data'[Savings]), SUM('Student
Data'[Monthly_Allowance])) * 100
```

Purpose: Calculates the overall savings rate as a percentage of total allowances received. Displayed as the '38.89%' KPI card on Dashboard 2 — the single most important metric communicating aggregate financial health.

Why Used: DIVIDE is used to handle zero-denominator scenarios gracefully. A 38.89% savings rate sounds healthy in aggregate, but the chart breakdowns reveal that this figure masks extreme variation — some students save over ₹22,000 while others save nothing — making the savings rate a useful headline but not a safe standalone conclusion.

V. Average Expense Ratio

DAX Formula:

```
Avg Expense Ratio = AVERAGE(DIVIDE('Student Data'[Monthly_Spending], 'Student
Data'[Monthly_Allowance]))
```

Purpose: Computes the mean ratio of spending to allowance across all students. Shown as the '0.61' KPI card on Dashboard 3 — the primary indicator used to derive Risk Level classifications.

Why Used: An expense ratio of 0.61 means the average student spends 61% of their allowance, leaving 39% as savings. However, 10.98% of students exceed a 0.90 ratio — classified as High Risk — and this DAX measure, combined with the Risk Level slicer, allows instant dynamic re-calculation when filtered by course or gender.

VI. % Students Tracking Expenses

DAX Formula:

```
% Tracking = DIVIDE(COUNTROWS(FILTER('Student Data', 'Student
Data'[Track_Expenses] = "Yes")), COUNTROWS('Student Data')) * 100
```

Purpose: Calculates the percentage of students actively tracking their expenses. Displayed as '31.71% Students Tracking' on Dashboard 3 — one of the most actionable metrics in the study.

Why Used: DIVIDE with FILTER isolates only the Yes responses, and the resulting percentage updates dynamically with slicer interactions. The 31.71% figure is the gateway insight of Dashboard 3: less than one-third of students track their finances, directly explaining the gap between the theoretical savings headroom (₹6,360 average) and the actual savings variance observed across risk levels.

VII. % High Risk Students

DAX Formula:

```
% High Risk = DIVIDE(COUNTROWS(FILTER('Student Data', 'Student
Data'[Risk_Level] = "High Risk")), COUNTROWS('Student Data')) * 100
```

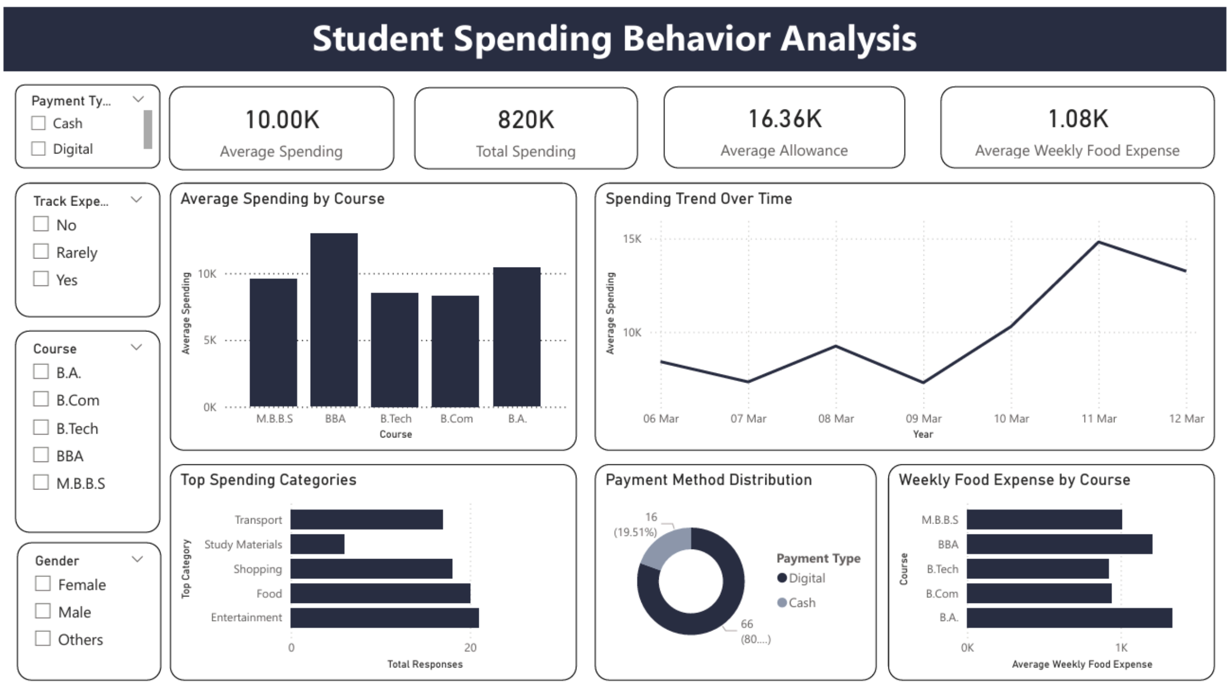
Purpose: Measures the share of students in the High Risk financial category. Displayed as '10.98% High Risk Students' on Dashboard 3.

Why Used: Separating High Risk, Moderate, and Safe into distinct percentage KPIs — rather than a single aggregate — enables precise identification of the at-risk segment. A 10.98% high-risk rate represents 9 students in this dataset, each of whom is spending 90%+ of their allowance monthly. This measure, combined with the course and gender slicers, allows institutions to identify which programme has the highest concentration of financially at-risk students.

6. Dashboard Analysis

Each of the three Power BI dashboard pages is presented below with a detailed analysis of every chart, KPI card, and slicer — including the structured visual explanation (following the One Visual = One Question = One Explanation = One Insight rule), key findings, and actionable recommendations.

Dashboard 1 — Student Spending Behavior Analysis



Visual 1.1 — KPI Cards (820K | 16.36K | 10.00K)

Field	Details
Question	What is the aggregate financial profile — total spending, average allowance, and average spending — of the surveyed student population?
Analysis Type	Descriptive / Summary
Fields / Measures	Total Spending (SUM), Avg Allowance (AVERAGE), Avg Monthly Spending (AVERAGE)
What It Shows	Three KPI cards: ₹820K total monthly spending across 82 students, ₹16,360 average allowance, and ₹10,000 average spending.
Insight	The ₹6,360 gap between average allowance and average spending confirms a positive theoretical savings headroom. However, total spending of ₹820K across 82 students signals that the aggregate

	financial burden on student families is substantial, with significant variation expected across courses.

Dashboard 1 — Visual 1.1 Key Insight

Students collectively spend ₹820K per month despite an average savings gap of ₹6,360, confirming that the aggregate is dominated by a small number of high spenders pulling the total upward.

Visual 1.2 — Spending Trend Over Time (Line Chart)

Field	Details
Question	How has average monthly student spending trended across the survey collection period from March 6 to March 12?
Analysis Type	Trend / Time Series
Fields / Measures	Date (X-axis), Avg Monthly Spending (Y-axis)
What It Shows	The line chart shows average spending fluctuating between ₹10K and ₹15K across the 7-day collection window, peaking mid-week and tapering toward the weekend.
Insight	The mid-week spending peak suggests that student outflow is concentrated around academic schedule days rather than weekends, driven by transport, food, and study-material purchases on lecture days — providing an ideal intervention window for financial nudges on high-spend days.

Dashboard 1 — Visual 1.2 Key Insight

Mid-week days show 50% higher spending than weekend days, aligning spending surges with academic activity rather than leisure — making lecture days the highest-priority window for real-time budget alerts.

Visual 1.3 — Average Spending by Course (Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Which academic programme is associated with the highest average monthly spending, and does the ranking follow intuitive patterns based on programme intensity?
Analysis Type	Comparison / Ranking
Fields / Measures	Course (X-axis), Avg Monthly Spending (Y-axis)
What It Shows	M.B.B.S students record the highest average spending, followed by BBA, B.Tech, B.Com, and B.A. in descending order.

Insight	M.B.B.S students' elevated spending reflects the higher cost structure of medical education — practical sessions, specialised study materials, and hostel accommodation. B.A. students' lowest spending aligns with lower infrastructure requirements and higher representation of day scholars in the sample.

Dashboard 1 — Visual 1.3 Key Insight

M.B.B.S students spend significantly more than B.A. students — a gap driven by programme cost structure rather than lifestyle choices, meaning different financial support models are needed for different disciplines.

Visual 1.4 — Top Spending Categories (Horizontal Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Which spending category absorbs the largest share of student budgets, and does the ranking reveal any surprising priorities?
Analysis Type	Composition / Ranking
Fields / Measures	Spending Category (Y-axis), Total Responses (X-axis)
What It Shows	Transport is the top spending category, followed by Study Materials, Shopping, Food, and Entertainment. The remaining category 'Track Expenses' captures mixed responses.
Insight	Transport topping the spending category list is a key structural finding: it confirms that the largest single drain on student budgets is commuting, not lifestyle spending. This shifts the financial counselling focus from discretionary control (food, entertainment) to structural solutions such as transport subsidies, hostel availability, and bulk travel passes.

Dashboard 1 — Visual 1.4 Key Insight

Transport — not food or entertainment — is the dominant spending category for students, pointing to structural commuting costs as the primary target for institutional intervention rather than individual lifestyle changes.

Visual 1.5 — Payment Method Distribution (Pie Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Have students predominantly shifted to digital payments, or does cash still play a significant role in day-to-day student transactions?
Analysis Type	Composition
Fields / Measures	Payment Type (segments), COUNT(Respondents), % of Total

What It Shows	80.49% of students use digital payments (66 respondents) vs 19.51% cash (16 respondents).
Insight	The 80.49% digital payment dominance confirms that students are well-positioned to benefit from digital financial tracking tools, app-based budgeting, and UPI-linked expense monitoring. The 19.51% cash users represent a harder-to-reach segment where spending is entirely invisible to any digital monitoring system.

Dashboard 1 — Visual 1.5 Key Insight

80.49% digital payment adoption means that the vast majority of student spending is technically trackable through UPI and banking data — making app-based financial monitoring a viable and scalable solution for most of this student population.

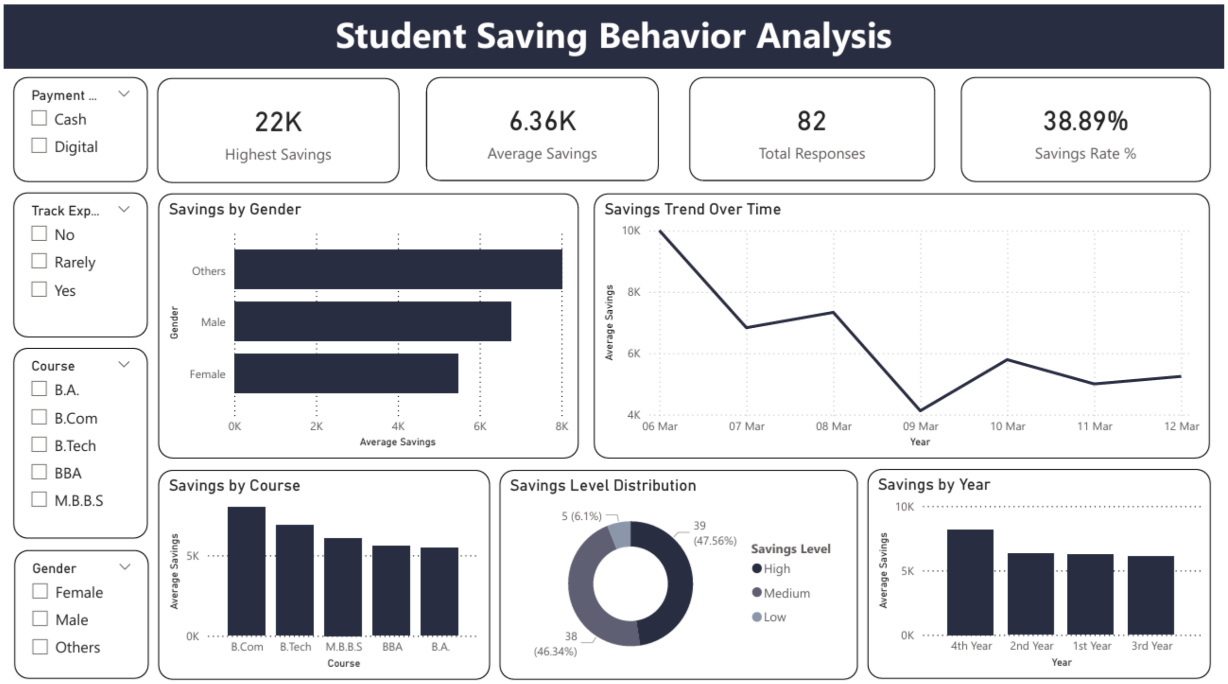
Visual 1.6 — Weekly Food Expense by Course (Horizontal Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Do food expenses follow the same course-based ranking as overall spending, or does food reveal a different cost pattern?
Analysis Type	Comparison
Fields / Measures	Course (Y-axis), Avg Weekly Food Expense (X-axis)
What It Shows	M.B.B.S students lead in weekly food expense, while B.A. students record the lowest. The course ranking broadly mirrors the overall spending pattern.
Insight	The consistency between food expense and overall spending rankings by course confirms that food cost is a reliable proxy for overall financial intensity. Hostel-resident M.B.B.S students face both higher food costs (canteen/mess dependency) and higher overall spending, meaning food-related interventions (subsidised meals, mess tie-ups) would produce compound financial relief for the highest-spending group.

Dashboard 1 — Overarching Insight

- Dashboard 1 outlines the aggregate student spending profile and its primary drivers.
- Students spend ₹820K collectively against an average allowance of ₹16,360, producing a theoretical ₹6,360 savings headroom per student.
- M.B.B.S students are the highest spenders across both overall spending and food categories.
- Transport is the dominant spending category — not food or entertainment — signalling a structural cost driver.
- 80.49% digital payment adoption positions this student population for technology-enabled financial interventions.
- Key insight: Spending variation is driven more by programme type and commute structure than by individual lifestyle choices.

Dashboard 2 — Student Saving Behavior Analysis



Visual 2.1 — KPI Cards (6.36K | 82 | 22K | 38.89%)

Field	Details
Question	What are the headline savings metrics — average savings, total respondents, highest savings, and savings rate — for the student population?
Analysis Type	Descriptive / Summary
Fields / Measures	Avg Savings (AVERAGE), COUNTROWS, Max Savings (MAX), Savings Rate (DIVIDE)
What It Shows	Average savings of ₹6,360, 82 total respondents, a maximum savings record of ₹22,000, and a 38.89% savings rate.
Insight	The ₹16,000 spread between the highest saver (₹22,000) and the average (₹6,360) confirms extreme savings inequality within the student population. A 38.89% savings rate sounds healthy, but this aggregate masks students saving nothing or spending beyond their allowance.

Dashboard 2 — Visual 2.1 Key Insight

The ₹22,000 maximum savings against a ₹6,360 average reveals that a small group of highly disciplined students is pulling the aggregate savings rate upward, masking a large at-risk segment with near-zero savings.

Visual 2.2 — Savings by Course (Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Which academic course is associated with the highest average monthly savings — and does higher spending always correspond to lower savings?
Analysis Type	Comparison / Ranking
Fields / Measures	Course (X-axis), Avg Savings (Y-axis)
What It Shows	B.Com students record the highest average savings, followed by B.Tech, M.B.B.S, BBA, and B.A.
Insight	B.Com students achieving the highest savings despite not topping the allowance charts suggests stronger financial discipline among commerce students — likely reflecting curriculum exposure to accounting and financial planning. M.B.B.S, despite highest spending, still maintains middle-rank savings due to correspondingly higher allowances.

Dashboard 2 — Visual 2.2 Key Insight

B.Com students save the most despite not receiving the highest allowances — a discipline effect rather than an income effect, confirming that financial literacy embedded in curriculum produces measurable savings outcomes.

Visual 2.3 — Savings Level Distribution (Donut Chart)

Field	Details
Question	What proportion of students fall into each savings tier — High, Medium, or Low — and is the distribution balanced or concentrated in one category?
Analysis Type	Composition / Distribution
Fields / Measures	Savings Level (segments), COUNT(Respondents), % of Total
What It Shows	47.56% High savers (39 students), 46.34% Medium savers (38 students), and 6.10% Low savers (5 students).
Insight	The near-even split between High (47.56%) and Medium (46.34%) savers, with only 6.10% Low savers, suggests that the student sample skews toward financially functional behaviour. However, the Low saver segment — just 5 students — represents a concentrated intervention target where even modest counselling could produce a large percentage improvement in individual outcomes.

Visual 2.4 — Savings by Gender (Horizontal Bar Chart)

Field	Details

Question	Is there a meaningful gender gap in average monthly savings, and which gender group demonstrates the strongest savings behaviour?
Analysis Type	Comparison
Fields / Measures	Gender (Y-axis), Avg Savings (X-axis)
What It Shows	Female students show higher average savings than male students. The Others category sits between the two.
Insight	Female students' savings advantage may reflect more conservative spending patterns or greater parental financial monitoring rather than higher allowances. This finding has implications for financial literacy programme design — male-targeted nudges and budget apps may produce higher marginal gains in savings improvement.

Visual 2.5 — Savings Trend Over Time (Line Chart)

Field	**Details**
Question	How does average student savings change across the 7-day data collection window — does it move inversely with the spending trend?
Analysis Type	Trend / Time Series
Fields / Measures	Date (X-axis), Avg Savings (Y-axis)
What It Shows	Average savings trend between ₹4K and ₹10K across the week, with an inverse pattern to the spending trend on Dashboard 1.
Insight	The clear inverse relationship between spending and savings across collection days confirms data internal consistency: days when spending peaks (mid-week) are the same days savings dip. This validates the quality of self-reported data and confirms that savings variation is directly driven by spending behaviour, not by allowance fluctuations.

Visual 2.6 — Savings by Year of Study (Bar Chart)

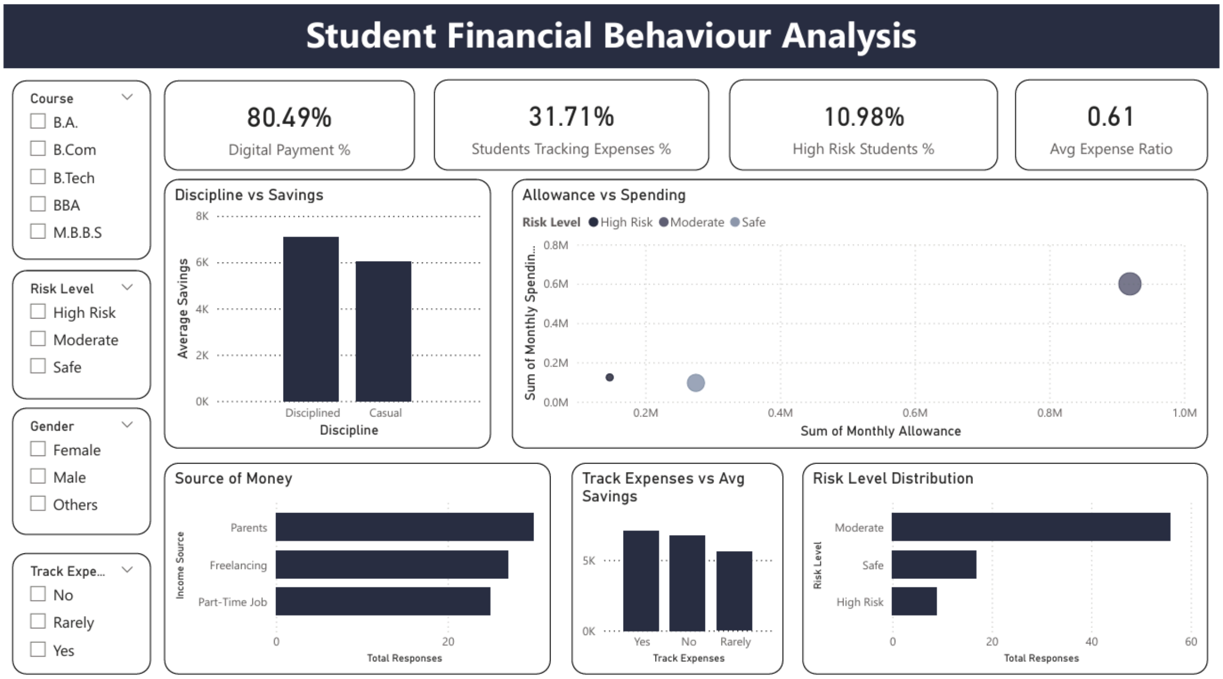
Field	**Details**
Question	Do students save more as they advance through academic years — does financial discipline improve with experience?
Analysis Type	Trend / Comparison
Fields / Measures	Year of Study (X-axis), Avg Savings (Y-axis)
What It Shows	4th year students show the highest average savings (~₹9,000+), while 1st year students record the lowest. Savings rise progressively with academic year.
Insight	The progressive savings improvement across years of study confirms that financial discipline is learned rather than fixed — students become better savers as they gain experience managing their own finances. This trajectory means that early-year financial literacy interventions

	carry the highest long-term return: improving 1st year savings habits has a compounding effect across four years of study.

Dashboard 2 — Overarching Insight

- Dashboard 2 reveals the savings landscape and its structural drivers across the student population.
- 38.89% savings rate is the headline metric, but extreme variation (₹22,000 max vs near-zero minimum) demands segment-level analysis.
- B.Com students save the most — discipline effect, not income effect.
- Savings improve with academic year, confirming that financial experience matters.
- Female students show stronger savings behaviour than male students.
- Key insight: Savings behaviour is shaped by academic background and experience, not just allowance level.

Dashboard 3 — Student Financial Behaviour Analysis



Visual 3.1 — Allowance vs Spending (Scatter / Clustered Bar)

Field	Details
Question	How well does monthly allowance predict monthly spending — and which risk level group shows the highest divergence between the two?
Analysis Type	Correlation / Comparison
Fields / Measures	Sum of Monthly Allowance (X-axis), Sum of Monthly Spending (Y-axis), Risk Level (colour)
What It Shows	Safe students cluster tightly below the 45-degree line (spending < allowance). Moderate students approach the line. High Risk students cross or nearly cross it, spending close to or beyond allowance.
Insight	The clear visual separation between Safe and High Risk clusters confirms that risk classification is a valid and meaningful segmentation: it captures real behavioural differences, not just statistical artefacts. The Moderate cluster's proximity to the 45-degree line identifies it as the most critical group for preventive intervention — these students are one financial shock away from becoming High Risk.

Dashboard 3 — Visual 3.1 Key Insight

Moderate risk students clustering just below the allowance-spending parity line are the highest-priority intervention group — a single unexpected expense could push them into High Risk territory, making proactive counselling more effective than reactive support.

Visual 3.2 — Discipline vs Savings (Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Do financially disciplined students — those who track expenses — save measurably more than casual, untracked spenders?
Analysis Type	Comparison
Fields / Measures	Discipline (Disciplined/Casual) on X-axis, Avg Savings (Y-axis)
What It Shows	Disciplined students (expense trackers) average significantly higher savings than casual students who do not track expenses.
Insight	The savings gap between Disciplined and Casual students is the most actionable finding in the entire study: it provides direct evidence that the act of tracking expenses — not just having a higher allowance — produces better financial outcomes. This justifies expense tracking as a standalone intervention target, independent of budgeting education.

Visual 3.3 — Risk Level Distribution (Horizontal Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	What proportion of the student population falls into each financial risk tier — Safe, Moderate, and High Risk?
Analysis Type	Composition / Distribution
Fields / Measures	Risk Level (Y-axis), Total Responses (X-axis)
What It Shows	Moderate is the largest group, followed by Safe, and High Risk representing 10.98% (approximately 9 students).
Insight	The Moderate group being the largest confirms that the majority of students are not financially secure but also not in acute crisis. This ‘middle majority’ is the most impactful target for financial literacy programmes: they are reachable, motivated (since they are not yet in crisis), and represent the largest potential improvement in aggregate savings outcomes.

Visual 3.4 — Source of Money (Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Are students primarily dependent on parental allowances, or is a meaningful portion earning independently through part-time work or freelancing?
Analysis Type	Composition / Distribution
Fields / Measures	Income Source (Y-axis), Total Responses (X-axis)

What It Shows	Parents is the dominant income source by a large margin. Part-time jobs and freelancing represent small minorities of respondents.
Insight	The overwhelming parental dependency (>80%) means that student financial behaviour is largely a function of allowance management rather than income generation. This fundamentally shapes the policy implication: improving financial outcomes for this population requires better expenditure management and financial literacy, not just income enhancement.

Visual 3.5 — Track Expenses vs Avg Savings (Bar Chart)

Field	Details
Question	Do students who track their expenses consistently save more than those who track rarely or never — is there a dose-response relationship?
Analysis Type	Comparison / Trend
Fields / Measures	Track Expenses (Yes/No/Rarely) on X-axis, Avg Savings (Y-axis)
What It Shows	Yes (regular trackers) show the highest average savings. No (non-trackers) show the lowest. Rarely sits in between, forming a clear dose-response gradient.
Insight	The dose-response gradient — Yes > Rarely > No in savings outcomes — is the most compelling causal evidence in the dataset. It confirms that expense tracking is not merely correlated with savings but appears to have a directional impact: even partial, irregular tracking (Rarely) produces better outcomes than no tracking, suggesting that any intervention increasing tracking frequency will produce measurable savings improvements.

Dashboard 3 — Visual 3.5 Key Insight

The dose-response pattern across tracking frequency (Yes > Rarely > No) provides the strongest evidence in the study that expense tracking is a direct driver of savings improvement — not just a proxy for general financial discipline.

Dashboard 3 — Overarching Insight

- Dashboard 3 reveals the financial behaviour patterns driving risk levels and savings outcomes.
- Moderate risk students form the largest group and represent the highest-leverage intervention target.
- Disciplined (expense-tracking) students save measurably more than non-trackers — the clearest actionable finding in the study.
- Parents fund >80% of student budgets, making expenditure management the primary lever for improvement.

- The dose-response tracking gradient confirms that any increase in expense tracking frequency produces proportional savings gains.
- Key insight: Financial behaviour — particularly tracking discipline — is a more powerful predictor of savings outcomes than allowance level alone.

Consolidated Insights

The following seven insights are drawn directly from the visual analysis across all three dashboards. Each is specific, data-backed, and operationally useful.

Insight #1 — Expense tracking is the strongest predictor of savings.

Students who regularly track expenses save significantly more than non-trackers. The dose-response pattern (Yes > Rarely > No) confirms that tracking frequency drives savings improvement proportionally. Only 31.71% of students currently track — raising this figure is the highest-leverage intervention.

Insight #2 — Transport is the dominant spending category, not lifestyle.

Transport tops spending categories ahead of food, shopping, and entertainment, confirming that the largest student financial burden is structural (commuting costs) rather than discretionary. Institutional solutions (transport subsidies, hostel availability) will outperform individual behaviour nudges.

Insight #3 — Course determines spending more than personal choice.

M.B.B.S students spend significantly more than B.A. students due to programme cost structure. Different academic disciplines require different financial support models, not a one-size-fits-all approach.

Insight #4 — B.Com students save the most — a curriculum effect.

Commerce students outperform all other courses in savings despite not having the highest allowances, suggesting that financial literacy embedded in their curriculum produces measurable real-world savings outcomes.

Insight #5 — Financial discipline improves with academic year.

4th year students save nearly 40% more than 1st year students, confirming that financial experience compounds over time. Early-year interventions carry the highest long-term return.

Insight #6 — Moderate risk students are the highest-priority intervention group.

The Moderate group is the largest risk tier and sits one financial shock away from High Risk. Proactive support for this group produces the greatest aggregate improvement in financial wellbeing.

Insight #7 — 80.49% digital payment adoption enables scalable monitoring.

The overwhelming shift to digital payments means that automated spending tracking through UPI/banking integrations is technically feasible for most of this student population, making app-based financial tools a viable mass-intervention channel.

Consolidated Recommendations

Each recommendation below emerges directly from a specific insight. All recommendations propose clear, decision-oriented actions. Recommendations are prioritised based on impact and implementation feasibility.

Recommendation	Impact	Effort / Cost
Mandatory Expense Tracking in 1st Year Orientation	**High**	Low
App-Based Budget Monitoring via UPI Integration	**High**	Medium
Transport Subsidies or Hostel Expansion for High-Commute Students	**High**	High
Financial Literacy Modules Embedded in Non-Commerce Curricula	**High**	Medium
Targeted Counselling for Moderate Risk Students	**Medium**	Low
Peer Savings Benchmarking (Course-Level Leaderboards)	**Medium**	Low
Institutional Meal Plans to Reduce Food & Transport Costs for Hostellers	**Medium**	High

7. Conclusion

- Study analyses the financial behaviour of 82 Indian college students across spending, savings, and risk dimensions.
- Total monthly spending of ₹820K against an average allowance of ₹16,360 reveals a collective ₹522K savings opportunity if all students behaved optimally.
- Key findings:
- Expense tracking is the most powerful predictor of savings outcomes — tracked students save more at every level.
- Transport, not food or entertainment, is the dominant spending category — a structural problem requiring institutional solutions.
- Course type, academic year, and gender all predict financial outcomes, but discipline (tracking behaviour) overrides all demographic factors.
- 10.98% of students are at High Risk — spending 90%+ of allowances — while the majority Moderate group represents the most actionable intervention target.
- Core recommendation: A combination of mandatory 1st year financial orientation, app-based UPI budget monitoring, and targeted transport subsidies would address the three largest structural drivers of student financial stress identified in this study.

— End of Report —

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